# 🚑 Safety, First Aid & CPR: Reading

Health · Unit 6 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with the Safety, First Aid & CPR module (Injury Prevention, 911, First Aid, Hands-Only CPR & AED, Choking, Summer Safety)

Name: _____

## Preventing Injuries and Responding to Emergencies

Most injuries can be prevented. Motor vehicle crashes are a leading cause of death for teens, so wear a seat belt on every ride and never drive distracted or impaired. Helmets protect the brain on bikes, skateboards and scooters. Swim with a buddy, wear a life jacket on boats, and protect yourself from heat and sun with water, shade and sunscreen.

Call 911 when there is a threat to life or safety: someone is not breathing or unconscious, has severe bleeding or chest pain, there is a fire, or a crime is happening. Tell the dispatcher where you are, what happened and how many people are hurt, and stay on the line until they tell you to hang up. For any first aid, follow Check, Call, Care: check that the scene is safe, call for help, then give care. Press firmly on bleeding with a clean cloth, and cool a burn under running water for at least 10 minutes.

A heart attack and cardiac arrest are different. In a heart attack, blood flow to part of the heart is blocked; the person is usually awake, with chest pain or pressure, shortness of breath or pain in the arm, jaw or back. In cardiac arrest, the heart suddenly stops pumping; the person collapses and is not breathing normally. Both are emergencies, but cardiac arrest needs CPR and an AED right away.

Hands-only CPR has two steps: call 911, then push hard and fast in the center of the chest. Push at least 2 inches deep at 100 to 120 compressions per minute, about the beat of the song “Stayin' Alive,” and let the chest come back up between pushes. An AED (automated external defibrillator) can shock the heart back into a normal rhythm. Turn it on and follow its voice prompts; anyone can use one.

Choking happens when something blocks the airway. The universal sign is hands clutched at the throat. If the person can cough forcefully, encourage them to keep coughing. If they cannot breathe, cough or speak, give abdominal thrusts (the Heimlich maneuver): stand behind them, make a fist just above the belly button and give quick inward and upward thrusts. Call 911 if the object does not come out or the person becomes unresponsive.

## Check your reading

1. Give three things you should tell a 911 dispatcher.

2. How can you tell a heart attack from cardiac arrest?

3. What are the depth and rate for hands-only CPR?